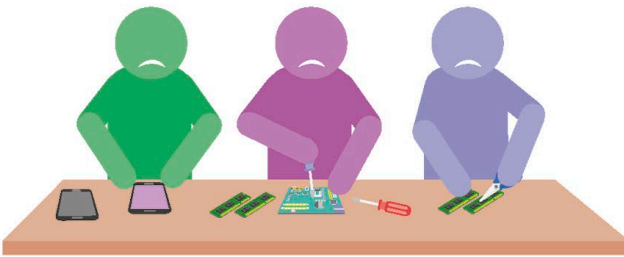


Ethics

There are many ethical issues surrounding the digital divide. For example, installing up-to-date internet communication cables in developing countries is likely to be time-consuming and costly, with the process potentially disadvantaging a country financially in the short and medium term. Some companies have provided internet access to users in developing countries, but the only sites users could access without paying belonged to that company, and the sites they approved of.

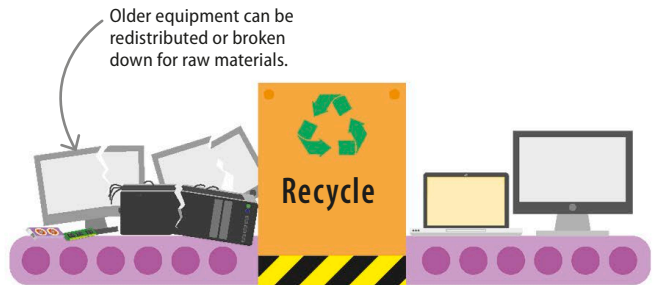


△ Exploitation

People in developing countries are often exploited by having to work long hours making technology for prosperous countries, with little or no chance of being able to afford what they make.

The environment

The effect of making digital devices on the environment is significant, and usually felt more in developing countries. Several of the components in smartphones are made from rare materials, such as gold and coltan. Sometimes the mining of these materials has both caused and funded serious conflict. The process of refining these metals also tends to produce toxic waste. Lastly, people tend not to dispose of their old digital technology properly, and this can produce toxic waste.

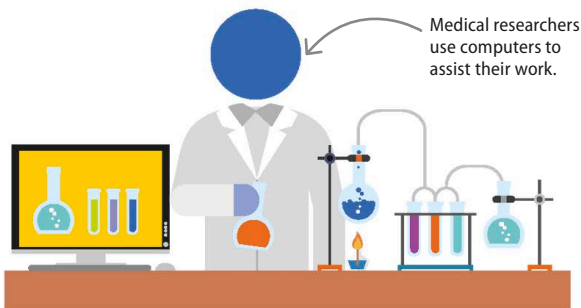


△ Recycling computers

Some organizations redistribute old, but working, computers to charities, including those in developing countries. Other companies recycle components of broken equipment into raw materials that can be used to make new devices.

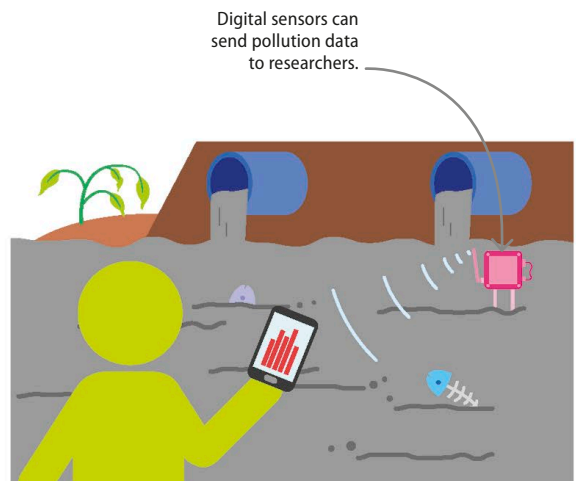
"Never before in history has innovation offered promise of so much to so many in so short a time."

Bill Gates (b. 1955), American co-founder of Microsoft



△ Healthcare and well-being

Digital technology means faster public health reporting and tracking, especially during epidemics. Researchers are also using digital technology to reduce the time taken to develop new treatments for illnesses.



△ Protecting the environment

Various projects use digital technology and internet connectivity to protect the environment. For example, underwater sensors can give researchers accurate real-time data about various pollutants.